



M/J Civics

CPALMS 2106010 | Grade 8 | Fall Semester | 5 Days/Week | 250 min/week

Family
Course
Overview

Note for Families: This overview reflects the planned course structure. Specific assignments, pacing, and assessments may be adjusted by your teacher. Always refer to your Canvas course for the most current information.

An in-depth study of the U.S. constitutional system, civic participation, individual rights, and government. Students trace the origins of American democracy from Greco-Roman and Enlightenment foundations through the Constitution, the Bill of Rights, civil liberties, and civic participation.

Semester at a Glance

Quarter 1 — Weeks 1–9

- Wk 1** Greco-Roman: Athenian Democracy
- Wk 2** Greco-Roman: Roman Republic
- Wk 3** Enlightenment: Natural Law of Hobbes and Locke
- Wk 4** Enlightenment: Montesquieu and Rousseau
- Wk 5** Declaration of Independence and Articles of Confederation
- Wk 6** Constitutional Convention
- Wk 7** The Federalist Papers: Republicanism and Federalism
- Wk 8** The Federalist Papers: Branches of Government
- Wk 9** Article I: Legislative Branch

Quarter 2 — Weeks 10–18

- Wk 10** Article II: Executive Branch
- Wk 11** Article III: Judicial Branch
- Wk 12** Bill of Rights
- Wk 13** Landmark Civil Liberties Cases: 1st Amendment
- Wk 14** Landmark Civil Liberties Cases: 4th, 5th, 6th Amendments
- Wk 15** Landmark Civil Rights Cases: Plessy v. Ferguson, Brown v. Board of Education
- Wk 16** Civic Participation: Voting, Juries, Military Service
- Wk 17** International: U.S. Foreign Policy
- Wk 18** International: Other Governmental Systems

What a Typical Week Looks Like

Readings & Lessons

- READ** 2–3 assigned readings or lesson pages in Canvas per module
- DISC** 1 discussion post with a question prompt, plus replies to classmates

Weekly Time Commitment

- Class meets **5 days/week**, totaling **250 minutes of instruction** per week
- Estimated additional independent work: **1–2 hours/week**
- Discussion posts typically due mid-week; assignments by Friday

On-Demand Students

Work through modules at your own pace within the semester window. Deadlines appear in Canvas — aim to complete at least one section per day. Reach your teacher via Canvas messages.

Assignments & Assessments

- PROJECT** 1 module project (analysis, graphic organizer, or short essay) per unit
- QUIZ** Reading comprehension quiz at the end of each reading assignment
- EXAM** Module exam at the conclusion of each major unit

What Students Need

- Reliable internet access and a Canvas-compatible device
- A Canvas account (provided by the school)
- Notebook or digital document for notes
- All readings provided in Canvas — no textbook purchase required

Live School Students

Follow a structured weekly schedule with live sessions. Readings open Monday; discussions due Wednesday; projects and quizzes due Friday. Attend live sessions and check Canvas daily.